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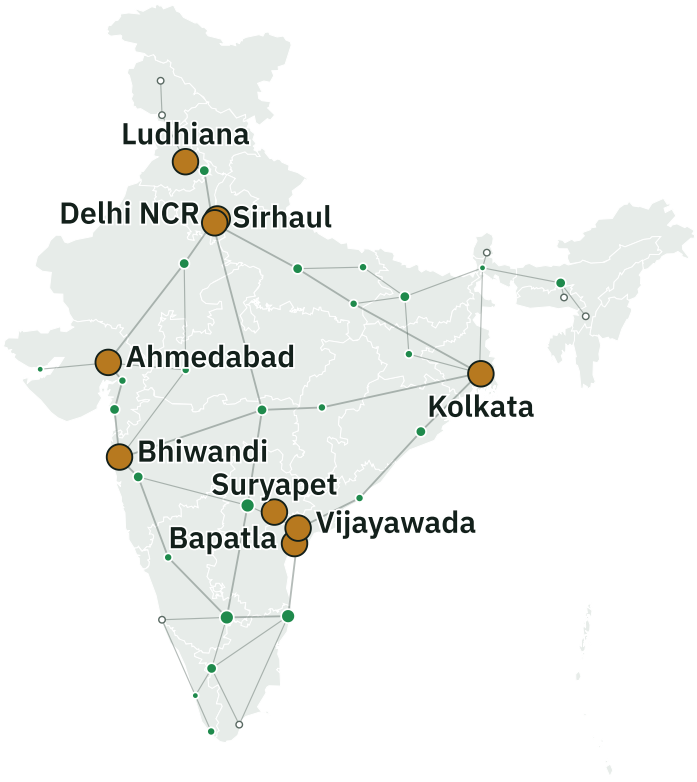
Cyclone Murasu costs the Chennai–Kolkata corridor two delivery days

● NETWORK: AMBER

BEFORE DIWALI · 4 DAYS TO DHANTERAS · 6 DAYS TO DIWALI

For e-commerce, D2C and consumer-goods teams delivering orders and stocking shops through Diwali.

Four days before Dhanteras, Murasu is due to come ashore near Bapatla early on Tuesday, and IMD has red alerts out today from Krishna down to Nellore[1]. And the worst of the rain? On the Chennai–Kolkata highway and at Vijayawada's junction, on the last good shipping days before the 6th. Delhi's first day of turning away older goods vehicles queued the Gurugram border. And the crews who sort and deliver in the big cities are leaving for Chhath, with the trains back full till the 22nd.



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

● GREEN normal for peak week: busy, but delivery promises hold
● AMBER something is slowing deliveries beyond normal peak
● RED deliveries largely stopped across a state or city, or a courier embargo on the route

DATES THAT MATTER

- **Since Wed 21 Oct** Delhi on Stage I of GRAP, its pollution action plan[2]
- **Until Thu 12 Nov** Pune's old-city markets take goods vehicles only at night
- **Mon 2 – Tue 3 Nov** Cyclone Murasu crosses the coast near Bapatla
- **Fri 6 – Sat 7 Nov** Warehouse crews leave Delhi, Ludhiana, Mumbai and Kolkata
- **Tue 10 – Sat 14 Nov** Gujarat's markets and transport shut till Labh Pancham
- **Fri 13 – Mon 16 Nov** Chhath keeps east UP and Bihar crews away from city hubs
- **Tue 17 – Sun 22 Nov** Crews' trains back to Delhi, Mumbai and Gujarat run full

DELIVERY PROMISE BY REGION

North	West	South	East	Northeast	Central
+1*	+1*	+2–3*	+1*	+0	+0
AMBER	AMBER	AMBER	AMBER	GREEN	GREEN

* Likely impact (#days) on delivery promise up to Diwali within the region, specific to certain cities or pincodes, beyond what is expected for the season.

Murasu comes ashore near Bapatla, on the coast's main road and railway

South · Coastal Andhra, the Krishna delta and Telangana's road to Vijayawada

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

The state now expects Murasu to cross near Bapatla on Tuesday morning, under IMD red alerts from Krishna to Nellore[1,3], so a load that misses Monday likely waits till Wednesday.

- **Bapatla, Guntur and Prakasam, on NH-16** South · +2 to +3 days The storm comes ashore where NH-16, the Chennai–Kolkata highway, runs beside the east-coast railway. I'd expect both to slow or stop from Monday night, and parcels here to arrive Friday at best.
- **Vijayawada and the Krishna delta** South · +2 days Vijayawada's own district sits in Monday's heaviest rain band too, The Week reports[3]. Northbound trucks bunch up at Vijayawada when the coast road shuts, so I'd expect city and delta orders to arrive two days late, around Thursday.
- **Khammam, Suryapet and the Hyderabad–Vijayawada road (NH-65)** South · +1 day Telangana expects heavy to very heavy rain in Khammam and Suryapet on Monday and Tuesday[4], so I'd expect Hyderabad's loads to Andhra on NH-65 to run a day late.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Orders for Guntur, Bapatla and Prakasam booked from Monday likely miss Dhanteras on Fri 6 Nov, my estimate, so promise them for Diwali instead; Khammam and Suryapet need one extra day.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- For shops in Guntur, Bapatla and Ongole, the sweets and dry fruits already in town are likely the Diwali stock; a top-up sent after Monday reaches them by Thursday at best, my estimate.

Trains back to Delhi, Mumbai and Gujarat are full from 17 to 22 November

North, West, East · City warehouses and sort centres; their crews' homes in Bihar and east UP

AMBER · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Amar Ujala reports waiting lists over 100 on regular trains from Bihar to Delhi from 17 November, and no room on trains to Ahmedabad and Mumbai from the 17th to the 22nd[5]. So when are the loaders and riders back at work? Not before the third week of November, mind you, and that is the gap to plan for.

- **Kolkata's warehouses and sort centres** East · +1 day Eastern Railway has added unreserved specials from Howrah and Sealdah to Bihar and east UP[6]. I'd expect Kolkata's dispatches to run a day late from Thursday.
- **Delhi NCR and Ludhiana** North · +1 day I'd expect short-handed shifts here to about 23 November, so post-Diwali orders leave a day late.
- **Mumbai, Bhiwandi and Ahmedabad** West · +1 day With no seats back until the 22nd, I'd expect these warehouses to ship a day behind, and Gujarat's restart after Labh Pancham to start short.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Post-Diwali orders from Delhi, Mumbai, Ahmedabad and Kolkata warehouses likely arrive a day late until 23 Nov, my estimate, so promise them a day longer.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- Plan full post-Diwali top-ups to shops from 23 Nov; until then depots in Gujarat, Mumbai and the NCR likely run a shift short, my estimate.

Delhi's borders with Gurugram, Noida and Ghaziabad

North · Day one of the BS-VI rule: queues at Sirhaul

AMBER

On Sunday the Delhi-bound side of NH-48 queued for nearly a kilometre at Sirhaul as police checked papers, Outlook reports[7]. Delhi's police sent back 714 of the 7,279 vehicles they checked, not saying how many carried goods[8]. I'd expect NCR vans to wait an hour or two at the border each morning, so Dhanteras top-ups run late unless they start earlier.

CALLS I'LL CHECK NEXT MONDAY

1. IMD reports Murasu crossing the Andhra coast between Nellore and Narsapur by the morning of 3rd November[9].
2. Delhi moves to Stage II of GRAP, or stricter, before Monday 9th November[2].
3. On 9th November, regular trains from Bihar to Delhi for the 17th still have waiting lists over 100[5].

SOURCES

1. The Federal: Andhra and Odisha brace for Murasu, 1 Nov
2. Outlook: GRAP Stage I invoked in Delhi-NCR, 21 Oct
3. The Week: red alert on the Andhra coast, 1 Nov
4. Telangana Today: heavy rain under Murasu, 1 Nov
5. Amar Ujala: trains back from Bihar full after Chhath, 1 Nov
6. Daily Jagran: unreserved specials from Bengal to Bihar, 1 Nov
7. Outlook: Delhi–Gurugram border jam as BS-VI curbs start, 1 Nov
8. The News Mill (ANI): Delhi police checks under GRAP, 2 Nov
9. DT Next: Murasu to cross 11:30 pm Monday to 4 am Tuesday, 1 Nov